WEBSITE UI REDESIGN

Project Guide: Usability Evaluation, Visual Design, and Responsive Layouts

Project objective	Redesign an existing website to make it easier to understand, navigate, and use across desktop and mobile devices.
Core deliverables	Heuristic evaluation, mood board, style guide, high-fidelity mockups, responsive layouts, and usability testing plan.
Suggested tools	Figma for design and prototyping; browser developer tools for responsive checks; HTML/CSS/JavaScript if implementing the design.

How to use this guide

Choose a real website to evaluate, document the problems you find, and redesign the most important user journeys first. Replace the example observations in this guide with findings from your selected website.

Design principle: make the next step obvious, keep the interface consistent, and ensure the experience works at every screen size.

1. Project Overview

The purpose of a website UI redesign is to improve the user's experience without changing the site's purpose. A good redesign uses evidence from the current interface, applies consistent visual rules, and tests whether users can complete common tasks more easily.

Objectives

• Identify usability problems in the existing interface.
• Improve information hierarchy, navigation, readability, and feedback.
• Establish a coherent visual language using a mood board and style guide.
• Create high-fidelity desktop and mobile mockups.
• Validate the redesign through responsive checks and usability testing.

Recommended workflow

Phase	Activities	Output
1. Discover	Choose the website, audience, and top user tasks.	Project brief
2. Evaluate	Review the interface against usability heuristics; capture evidence and severity.	Heuristic audit
3. Define	Prioritize issues and map the improved user flow.	Problem list and flow
4. Explore	Create mood board, colors, typography, and component rules.	Style guide
5. Design	Build wireframes and high-fidelity desktop/mobile screens.	Mockups and prototype
6. Validate	Test key tasks, check responsive breakpoints, and refine.	Test notes and final design

2. Heuristic Evaluation

Inspect the existing website and record specific examples. The following usability heuristics provide a practical checklist.

Heuristic	What to inspect	Severity (0–4)
Visibility of system status	Show loading, success, error, and progress states when relevant.	____
Match with the real world	Use familiar words, clear labels, and language users understand.	____
User control and freedom	Make it easy to go back, cancel, close, or undo where appropriate.	____
Consistency and standards	Keep navigation, buttons, icons, and terminology consistent.	____
Error prevention	Use helpful defaults, input constraints, and confirmation for destructive actions.	____
Recognition rather than recall	Keep options and instructions visible instead of making users remember them.	____
Flexibility and efficiency	Support common tasks efficiently without overwhelming beginners.	____
Minimalist design	Remove clutter and emphasize the content and actions that matter.	____
Help users recover from errors	Explain what went wrong and how to fix it in plain language.	____
Help and documentation	Provide concise help where users are likely to need it.	____

Severity scale

0 = not a usability issue; 1 = cosmetic; 2 = minor; 3 = major; 4 = critical issue that blocks an important task. Rate issues based on impact and frequency, not personal preference.

Issue log template

Page / task	Observed issue and evidence	Impact	Priority
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

3. Mood Board and Style Guide

A mood board establishes the visual direction before detailed screen design. Collect references for color, typography, imagery, icon style, spacing, and the overall tone. Keep the references aligned with the target audience and website purpose.

Example visual direction

Primary	Accent	Background	Text
#16324F	#1F8A8A	#F6F9FA	#25313B

These colors are an example starting point, not a requirement. Check text contrast and adapt the palette to the brand.

Typography and components

- Headings: use a clear sans-serif typeface with distinct size and weight levels.
- Body text: prioritize readability and comfortable line spacing.
- Buttons: use consistent heights, padding, corner radius, and clear action labels.
- Forms: label every field, show required fields, and provide specific error messages.
- Cards: use consistent spacing and alignment; avoid unnecessary borders and shadows.
- Icons: use one consistent icon family and pair unfamiliar icons with labels.

Suggested design tokens

Token	Example	Usage
Spacing	8 / 16 / 24 / 32 px	Use a consistent spacing scale.
Corner radius	8 px	Cards, fields, and buttons.
Content width	Around 1120–1200 px	Keep long lines from becoming difficult to scan.
Body text	16 px baseline	Adjust after testing readability.
Focus state	Visible outline	Support keyboard navigation.

4. High-Fidelity Mockups

Design the most important pages first. Start with a wireframe to establish structure, then apply the style guide. Include realistic content and important interface states rather than designing only an ideal empty screen.

Recommended screens

1. Home / landing page — clear headline, primary action, key information, and navigation.
2. Main task page — the central action or service users came to complete.
3. Details or results page — useful information, status, and next steps.
4. Form or checkout page, if relevant — labels, validation, error states, and confirmation.
5. Mobile navigation — compact menu and accessible touch targets.

Mockup review checklist

- ■ The most important action is visually prominent.
- ■ Page titles and section headings establish clear hierarchy.
- ■ Navigation labels are understandable and consistent.
- ■ Text and controls have sufficient contrast.
- ■ Buttons and links look different and behave predictably.
- ■ Loading, empty, success, and error states are considered.

5. Responsive Design

Responsive design allows a layout to adapt to different screen sizes and input methods. Design for the content and available space rather than relying only on specific device names.

Viewport (example)	Layout guidance
Mobile: 320–599 px	Single-column content, compact navigation, stacked forms, touch-friendly controls, and limited decorative elements.
Tablet: 600–1023 px	Use flexible columns where useful; adjust navigation and card grids to fit the available width.
Desktop: 1024 px and above	Use wider content areas, multi-column layouts, and persistent navigation when it improves task completion.

Responsive implementation checklist

- Use flexible widths, CSS Grid/Flexbox, and responsive images.
- Add breakpoints when the content needs them, not simply for device labels.
- Prevent horizontal scrolling at common viewport widths.
- Ensure text remains readable without zooming.
- Keep interactive targets comfortably large and separated.
- Test menus, dialogs, tables, forms, and media on touch and keyboard.
- Check both portrait and landscape orientations where relevant.

Example CSS media query

Use this as a starting point if you implement the design in code:

```
/* Mobile-first default styles */
.card-grid {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 1fr;
  gap: 1rem;
}

@media (min-width: 700px) {
  .card-grid {
    grid-template-columns: repeat(2, minmax(0, 1fr));
  }
}

@media (min-width: 1024px) {
  .card-grid {
    grid-template-columns: repeat(3, minmax(0, 1fr));
  }
}
```

6. Usability Testing and Validation

Ask a few representative users to complete realistic tasks using the prototype. Avoid telling them where to click; observe where they hesitate, make errors, or misunderstand labels.

Example test tasks

• Find a specific item, service, or page.
• Complete the website's main task.
• Change or correct an entered detail.
• Find help or recover from an error.
• Complete the same key task on a mobile screen.

Record task completion, time taken, errors, user comments, and confidence. Fix issues that block important tasks first, then retest the updated design.

7. Final Deliverables

■ Summary of the existing website and its intended audience.
■ Heuristic evaluation with evidence, severity, and priorities.
■ Mood board and documented design direction.
■ Style guide with colors, typography, spacing, and components.
■ High-fidelity desktop and mobile mockups.
■ Clickable prototype or implementation, if required.
■ Responsive and accessibility checks.
■ Usability test results and a short list of improvements.

Conclusion

A successful UI redesign is more than a visual refresh. It addresses observed usability issues, gives the interface a consistent design system, adapts to different screen sizes, and validates improvements through realistic tasks. Select a specific website and replace the example palette and checklist entries with your own evidence to make the project complete.

Reference tutorial supplied in the task: https://youtu.be/fcWahZqGU44?si=HvuqWHzZAg6dJl27